

# VSSC Onam Pookalam – Flower Purchase Guide

Practical planning guide for a circular 6-foot-diameter pookalam with an ISRO logo at the centre.

## 1. Basic Size Calculation

For a 6 ft diameter pookalam, the radius is 3 ft. The area is approximately  $\pi \times 3^2 = 28.3$  square feet. The quantities below are a practical starting estimate and should be adjusted after making a 1-square-foot sample with the actual flowers.

## 2. Suggested Colour Distribution

| Colour / Material | Approx. share | Area for 6-ft design | Suitable flowers/material             |
|-------------------|---------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Orange            | 30%           | 8.5 sq.ft            | Orange marigold                       |
| Yellow            | 25%           | 7.1 sq.ft            | Yellow marigold                       |
| White / Cream     | 20%           | 5.7 sq.ft            | White chrysanthemum / similar         |
| Purple            | 10%           | 2.8 sq.ft            | Purple aster / available local flower |
| Pink / Magenta    | 10%           | 2.8 sq.ft            | Pink flowers / petals                 |
| Green             | 5%            | 1.4 sq.ft            | Leaves / green foliage                |

## 3. Initial Flower Purchase Estimate

Because flower weight varies significantly by species, petal size and moisture, use these as starting quantities rather than exact scientific measurements. Include roughly 15–20% extra.

| Material             | Starting quantity | With ~15% extra | Purpose                    |
|----------------------|-------------------|-----------------|----------------------------|
| Orange marigold      | 2.1–2.5 kg        | 2.4–2.9 kg      | Outer rings and motifs     |
| Yellow marigold      | 1.8–2.2 kg        | 2.1–2.5 kg      | Main yellow sections       |
| White/cream flowers  | 1.4–1.8 kg        | 1.6–2.1 kg      | Background and ISRO centre |
| Purple flowers       | 0.7–0.9 kg        | 0.8–1.0 kg      | Inner ring / outlines      |
| Pink/magenta flowers | 0.7–0.9 kg        | 0.8–1.0 kg      | Petal motifs               |
| Green leaves         | As needed         | Extra 15–20%    | Outer border               |

## 4. Most Accurate Method Before Buying

**Step 1:** Choose the final design and measure its total diameter.

**Step 2:** Draw a 1 ft × 1 ft test square.

**Step 3:** Fill that square with the actual flower petals at the same thickness you will use in the pookalam.

**Step 4:** Weigh the petals used for each colour.

**Step 5:** Multiply each colour's 1-sq-ft quantity by the corresponding area in the design.

**Step 6:** Add 15–20% extra for wastage, damaged petals and final corrections.

## 5. Buying Checklist

- Orange marigold petals
- Yellow marigold petals
- White/cream petals
- Purple petals
- Pink/magenta petals
- Green leaves
- Extra flowers for repairs and finishing
- Clean sheets/trays or containers for separating colours
- Measuring tape and chalk/string for drawing circles
- Weighing scale for the 1-sq-ft test

## 6. ISRO Logo Centre

Keep the centre visually clean and use a contrasting light background. For a 6-ft pookalam, a centre circle of roughly 1.0–1.2 ft diameter is a reasonable starting point. Use the actual ISRO logo as the reference when arranging the orange and blue details. Avoid making the centre too small, because the logo should remain recognizable from a distance.

## 7. Important Practical Tips

- Buy flowers as fresh as possible, preferably close to the arrangement time.
- Separate petals by colour before starting the pookalam.
- Do not mix damaged or wet petals into the main batches.
- Keep white petals covered from dust and coloured petals separated to prevent staining.
- If the design is changed or the pookalam is larger than 6 ft, recalculate the quantities.
- The 1-sq-ft sample method is more reliable than converting flower counts directly into kilograms.

**Note:** The quantities in this guide are planning estimates for a 6-ft design. Actual requirement depends on flower type, petal size, layer thickness and how tightly the petals are packed. For an official VSSC event, make a small test section before placing the final order.